Placement Committee

Ashoka University
Career Development Office

THE COMPLETE INTERNSHIP TO PPO GUIDE



Brief Overview

Pre-Placement Offers (PPOs) are a critical outcome of internships, where a company extends a full-time role to an intern based on performance. PPOs reduce uncertainty during placement season, give students job security, ease the pressure of final placements, and allow for a faster career start.

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Structured PPO Programs

Performance -Based PPOs

02

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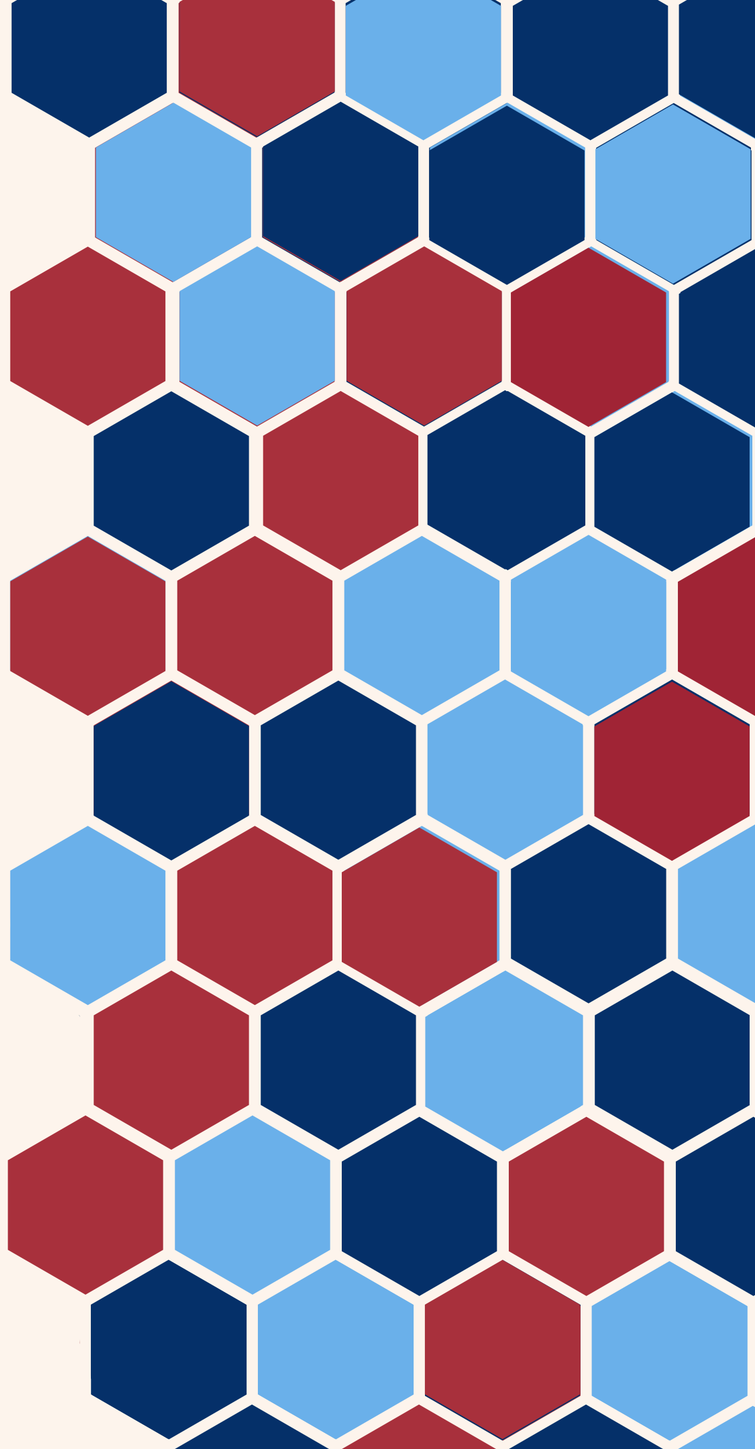
Manager-Initiated PPO (No Formal PPO Channel)

Accelerated / Preferred PPO (Prior Relationship)

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WHAT IS A PPO?

Pre-Placement Offers (PPOs) are a critical outcome of internships, **where a company extends a full-time role to an intern based on performance**. PPOs reduce uncertainty during placement season, give students **job security, ease the pressure of final placements,** and allow for a **faster career start**. PPOs generally fall into four categories:

1. **Structured PPO Programs** – Companies where the internship is explicitly designed as a pipeline for full-time hiring, such as BCG.

2. **Performance-Based PPOs** – Companies that do not guarantee PPOs but extend them to interns who deliver exceptional performance and stand out during the internship.

3. **Manager-Initiated Conversions** – Companies that do not formally offer PPOs, but where managers can initiate the process and recommend high-performing interns for full-time roles.

4. **Accelerated or Preferred Hiring for Previous Collaborations** – Companies that may not directly offer PPOs, but give preference or a fast-tracked hiring route to interns who have worked with them before, either through repeat internships, projects, or competitions.

1. STRUCTURED PPO PROGRAMS

Some companies run internships as **pipelines for full-time hiring**. Here, PPOs are part of a well-defined process and interns know that **conversion is a primary outcome.** In such companies, expectations are clear from the beginning. **Performance evaluations, feedback sessions, and final project presentations are central to determining PPO outcomes.**

Examples:

- **Boston Consulting Group (BCG):** Treats its internship as an extended evaluation for full-time associates. Conversion to a PPO is common for strong performers.
- **McKinsey & Company:** Uses a similar model. Interns receive continuous evaluation, mid-point check-ins, and a final review which often leads to PPOs.
- **Hindustan Unilever Limited (HUL):** Its summer internship program, along with case competitions like LIME, is designed with conversion in mind. PPOs are extended to top interns.
- **ITC Limited:** Runs a structured internship funnel where PPOs are frequently awarded.

2. PERFORMANCE-BASED PPOS

Other companies do not have a formal policy of converting interns. However, **they may extend PPOs to a select few who display exceptional talent, cultural fit, or unique impact.**

Examples:

- **Quant Trading Firms:** These firms are highly selective and may extend PPOs to exceptional candidates based on strong technical and analytical performance during the internship.

- **High-growth Technology Startups:** Many startups assess their hiring needs after the internship. If an intern adds visible value or demonstrates rare skills, the company may extend a PPO.

In this model, interns must go above and beyond expectations to be noticed. Offers are discretionary, based on both performance and organizational needs.

3. MANAGER-INITIATED PPO (NO FORMAL PPO CHANNEL)

This route occurs when a manager personally advocates for an intern, based on remarkable performance-even though there’s no structured PPO program.

Some Extra Tips

As highlighted by The Economic Times, standing out isn't just about long hours—visible results and initiative matter most.

- **Build Relationships and Communicate**

Establish rapport with your manager and team. Regular interactions and proactive updates make you more memorable.

- **Be Proactive About Expressing Interest**

Clearly state your desire to continue and ask about possibilities for conversion before your internship ends.

4. ACCELERATED / PREFERRED PPO (PRIOR RELATIONSHIP)

This applies to interns or individuals who have **previously engaged with a company (through internships, projects, or prior work)**. Their familiarity and proven track record often enable them to bypass standard hiring steps.

Some Extra Tips

- Refine and Showcase Your Resume Early
- Solicit Managerial Support and Feedback
- Leveraging manager and buddy networks to correct course and demonstrate capability is crucial in securing a PPO at firms like McKinsey.

BEST PRACTICES TO SECURE A PPO

During the Internship (60%)

- Clarify expectations in the first week by asking about deliverables and success measures.
- Take ownership of projects and go beyond assigned tasks.
- Provide regular progress updates to managers and mentors, asking for feedback along the way.
- Build relationships across teams, not just with your direct manager.
- Document your work and highlight measurable impact.
- Adapt to company culture and working style.

BEST PRACTICES TO SECURE A PPO

After the Internship (20%)

- Send thank-you notes to your manager, mentor, and team members expressing gratitude.
- Update LinkedIn with internship details and acknowledge the learning experience.
- Share academic progress or relevant projects with your manager or HR after the internship to stay visible.
- Express clear interest in returning and ask about conversion timelines.
- Maintain occasional contact with your mentor or team through polite, professional check-ins.

BEST PRACTICES TO SECURE A PPO

Company Culture and Policies (20%)

- Some companies have strong PPO pipelines, while others prefer waiting for final placements.
- Even strong performance may not guarantee a PPO if the company faces headcount freezes, restructuring, or limited hiring needs.
- Students should always perform their best but also keep backup opportunities in hand.

SOURCES

- Internship Opportunities | Careers | Boston Consulting Group
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